



MODDABLE CHESS

VARIANT LIBRARY

Every chess variant, one engine

102	2-6	10+
VARIANTS	PLAYERS	AGE

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VARIANT LIBRARY

Moddable Chess includes 102 playable variants spanning classic rules, asymmetric battles, hidden information, expanded boards, and alternative win conditions. Each variant has its own complete rules page.

STANDARD BOARD (8X8)

- ♦ [Standard Chess](#) – Classic FIDE rules
- ♦ [Absorption Chess](#) – Capturing piece gains the victim's movement permanently
- ♦ [Andernach Chess](#) – Capturing piece changes colour
- ♦ [Atomic](#) – Captures explode adjacent pieces
- ♦ [Benedict Chess](#) – Attacked enemies convert colour
- ♦ [Berserk Chess](#) – Check grants a bonus move
- ♦ [Checkless Chess](#) – No check unless it is checkmate
- ♦ [Crazyhouse](#) – Captured pieces switch sides and drop back onto the board
- ♦ [Cylinder Chess](#) – Files wrap, a-file connects to h-file
- ♦ [Dark Chess](#) – Only see squares your pieces occupy
- ♦ [Dice Chess](#) – Die roll constrains piece type
- ♦ [Displacement Chess](#) – Swap positions with adjacent friendly pieces
- ♦ [Duck Chess](#) – Place a blocker duck after each move
- ♦ [Einstein Chess](#) – Captures promote pieces, non-captures demote them
- ♦ [Extinction Chess](#) – Lose when any piece type is eliminated
- ♦ [Fischer Random](#) – 960 randomised starting positions
- ♦ [Fog of War](#) – Only see squares your pieces attack
- ♦ [Grid Chess](#) – Moves must cross a 2x2 grid line
- ♦ [Hoppel-Poppel](#) – Knights capture like bishops, bishops capture like knights
- ♦ [Horde Chess](#) – 36 pawns vs a normal army
- ♦ [Immunization Chess](#) – Captures make adjacent enemies immune for 2 turns
- ♦ [King of the Hill](#) – King reaches centre = instant win
- ♦ [Madras Chess](#) – Same-type opposing pieces paralyse each other
- ♦ [Maharaja & Sepoys](#) – One super-piece vs a full army
- ♦ [Marseillais](#) – Two moves per turn
- ♦ [Medusa Chess](#) – Queen petrifies enemy pieces she attacks
- ♦ [No Castling](#) – Standard chess, castling disabled
- ♦ [No Retreat](#) – Pieces cannot move backward
- ♦ [Patrol Chess](#) – Capture only when defended by a friendly piece
- ♦ [Poison Chess](#) – Capture squares become poisoned for 3 turns
- ♦ [Racing Kings](#) – No checks allowed, race King to rank 8
- ♦ [Recruitment Chess](#) – Captured pieces defect to the captor
- ♦ [Rifle Chess](#) – Capturing pieces stay on their square
- ♦ [Teleport Chess](#) – 3 teleports per game to any empty square

MULTI-MOVE VARIANTS

- ♦ [Monster Chess](#) – White gets 2 moves, Black gets 1
- ♦ [Progressive](#) – Escalating moves per turn (1, 2, 3, 4...)

ALTERNATIVE WIN CONDITIONS

- ♦ [Antichess](#) – Forced captures, lose all pieces to win
- ♦ [Chak](#) – 9x9 Mesoamerican chess; move your Warrior Ajaw to the opponent's temple and survive
- ♦ [Chennis](#) – 7x7; advance a Pawn to the opponent's back rank to win (no checkmate)
- ♦ [Codrus](#) – Lose your King to win, no check concept
- ♦ [Five-Check](#) – Five checks to win
- ♦ [Giveaway](#) – Forced captures, lose all pieces to win (stalemate = loss)
- ♦ [Omnicide](#) – Lose all pieces to win, captures NOT forced
- ♦ [Single-Check](#) – One check wins instantly
- ♦ [Stalemate Wins](#) – Stalemating your opponent wins
- ♦ [Suicide Chess](#) – Forced captures, lose all pieces to win (stalemate = draw)
- ♦ [Three-Check](#) – Deliver three checks to win
- ♦ [Ultima](#) – Seven unique capture methods; win by capturing the opponent's King

ASYMMETRIC ARMIES

- ♦ [Empire Chess](#) – FIDE Kingdom vs Empire; Empire pieces all move as Queen but capture piece-specifically; faceoff rule
- ♦ [Khan's Chess](#) – FIDE Kingdom vs Mongol Horde with Scout and Khatun; divergent pieces; campmate and stalemate-loss
- ♦ [Orda Chess](#) – FIDE vs divergent Horde army; all Horde pieces move as Knight
- ♦ [Shinobi Chess](#) – FIDE vs Shinobi Clan; hand drops; automatic zone promotion
- ♦ [Spartan Chess](#) – FIDE vs Spartan army with two Kings; dual-check rule
- ♦ [Synochess](#) – FIDE Kingdom vs Xiangqi-derived Eastern dynasty; Cannon, Chariot, Horse; faceoff rule

GATING & DROP MECHANICS

- ♦ [Mansindam](#) – 8x9 board; compound pieces (Cardinal, Marshal, Angel); Shogi-style drops + mandatory promotion; campmate; no draws
- ♦ [S-Chess](#) – Hawk and Elephant held in hand; gate onto vacated home squares when back-rank pieces move
- ♦ [Shogun Chess](#) – Shogi-style drops; captured pieces switch sides; promotion on ranks 6-8

PIECE REPLACEMENT & MOVEMENT VARIANTS

- ♦ [Alice Chess](#) – Two boards; pieces transfer between boards after each move
- ♦ [Almost Chess](#) – One queen replaced by Chancellor (R+N)
- ♦ [Amazon Chess](#) – Queens replaced by Amazons (Q+N)
- ♦ [Berolina Chess](#) – Pawns move diagonally and capture straight (inverted)
- ♦ [Chigorin](#) – White has 4 knights instead of bishops
- ♦ [Grasshopper Chess](#) – Hoppers replace Queens; must jump over a hurdle to land
- ♦ [Knightmate](#) – Knight is royal, King moves like a knight
- ♦ [Nightrider Chess](#) – Knights replaced by Nightriders; repeat Knight-moves in one direction
- ♦ [Orda Mirror](#) – Both sides Horde army; all pieces move as Knight, capture as FIDE counterpart
- ♦ [Wildebeest Chess](#) – Camel and Wildebeest (N+Camel) added to a 10x11 board

STARTING POSITION VARIANTS

- ♦ [Endgame Chess](#) – Only pawns and Kings from the start
- ♦ [Legan Chess](#) – Berolina pawns, King and Queen swap starting squares
- ♦ [Pawns Only](#) – Only pawns, first promotion wins
- ♦ [Peasants' Revolt](#) – King + pawns vs King + knights
- ♦ [Placement Chess](#) – Back-rank pieces placed during a setup phase before play begins
- ♦ [Upside-Down](#) – Pieces start on opponent's rank

REGIONAL & HISTORICAL VARIANTS

- ♦ [ASEAN Chess](#) – Standardised Makruk; pawns on rank 2, streamlined counting rules
- ♦ [Chaturanga](#) – Indian ancestor of chess, c. 600 CE. Weak counsellor and leaping elephant.
- ♦ [Makpong](#) – Thai variant, King cannot move out of check
- ♦ [Makruk](#) – Thai chess, pawns promote on rank 6 to Met
- ♦ [Ouk Chaktrang](#) – Cambodian chess; Koul leaps 1-2 diagonally; King may jump as Knight on first move
- ♦ [Shatar](#) – Mongolian chess, win by baring the opponent's King
- ♦ [Shatranj](#) – Medieval Islamic chess, ancestor of modern chess
- ♦ [Sittuyin](#) – Burmese chess, placement opening phase
- ♦ [Tamerlane Chess](#) – 11x10 board with citadels; 12 piece types; complex pawn promotion system

EXPANDED BOARDS

- ♦ [Capablanca Chess](#) – 10x8 with Archbishop + Chancellor
- ♦ [Courier Chess](#) – 12x8, medieval variant from 1202
- ♦ [Grand Chess](#) – 10x10, same new pieces, bigger stage
- ♦ [Gygax Chess](#) – Three stacked 12x8 boards; 42 pieces per side across 15 piece types
- ♦ [Shako](#) – 10x10; adds Cannon (platform capture) and Elephant (2-diagonal leap)

SMALL BOARDS

- ♦ [Breakthrough](#) – 7x7, pawns only, first to far rank wins
- ♦ [Diana Chess](#) – 6x6, no queens or knights
- ♦ [Half Chess](#) – 8x4, armies start adjacent
- ♦ [Los Alamos](#) – 6x6, no bishops, first computer chess (1956)
- ♦ [Minichess](#) – 5x5, full piece types on tiny board
- ♦ [Petty Chess](#) – 5x6, all piece types, single copies

HEXAGONAL BOARD

- ♦ [Brusky's Hexagonal Chess](#) – 84-hex irregular board, 10 files
- ♦ [De Vasa's Hexagonal Chess](#) – 81-hex rhombus (9x9), pawns start on rank 3
- ♦ [Gliński's Hexagonal Chess](#) – 91-hex board, the most widely played hex chess variant
- ♦ [McCooley's Hexagonal Chess](#) – 91-hex board, bishops start on same colour
- ♦ [Mini Hexchess](#) – Compact 37-hex board, one of each piece type
- ♦ [Shafran's Hexagonal Chess](#) – 70-hex board, 9 files (a-i)



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